

ART & CULTURE



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

MODULE - 1

HINDUISM AND ITS PHILOSOPHY

RELIGION – A QUICK INTRODUCTION



1 Religion is the **science of soul**.
Morality and ethics have their foundation on religion.

2 Religion played an important part in the **lives of the Indians** from the **earliest times**.

3 It assumed numerous forms in relation to different groups of people associated with them.

4 Religion in India was never static in character but was driven by an inherent dynamic strength.

5 Indian spirituality is deeply rooted in **ancient philosophical and religious traditions of the land**.

6 Philosophy arose in India as an enquiry into the **mystery of life and existence**.

HOW IS RELIGION IN ANCIENT INDIA LINKED WITH PHILOSOPHY?

1 Indian sages called **Rishis** or 'seers', developed **special techniques** of transcending the sense and the ordinary mind, collectively called **yoga**.

2 With the help of these techniques, they delved **deep into the depths of consciousness** and discovered important truths about the true nature of human being and the universe.

RELIGIOUS MYSTICS & THEIR PHILOSOPHY



3 CONCEPT OF ATMAN:

- The sages found that the true nature of the human being is not **the body or the mind**, which are **ever changing and perishable** but the **spirit** which is **unchanging**, immortal and pure consciousness. They called it the **Atman**.
- The Atman is the true source of human's knowledge, happiness and power.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

HOW IS RELIGION IN ANCIENT INDIA LINKED WITH PHILOSOPHY?

4 The rishis further found that all individual selves are parts of infinite consciousness which they called **Brahman**.

5 They said that **Brahman** is the **ultimate reality**, the ultimate cause of the universe.

6 Ignorance of human's true **nature** is the main cause of human suffering and bondage.

KNOWLEDGE
OF ATMAN &
BRAHMAN....
**TO ATTAIN
MOKSHA**

8 Hinduism in ancient India meant a **way of life** which enables a human to realize his true nature and **attain Moksha**.

7 By **gaining correct knowledge** of Atman and Brahman, it is possible to become free from **suffering** and bondage and attain a state of immortality, everlasting peace and fulfillment known as **Moksha**.

GOALS FOR LIFE	MEANING	TREATISE ON THE GOAL
Artha	Economic means or wealth	Matters related to the economy were discussed in Arthashastras.
Dharma	Regulations of social orders	Matters related to the state were discussed in the Dharmasastra.
Kama	Physical pleasures or love	The Kamasutra/ Kamasutra were written to elaborate on sexual matters.
Moksha	Salvation	There are several texts on philosophy that deal with salvation.

HOW IS RELIGION IN ANCIENT INDIA LINKED WITH PHILOSOPHY?

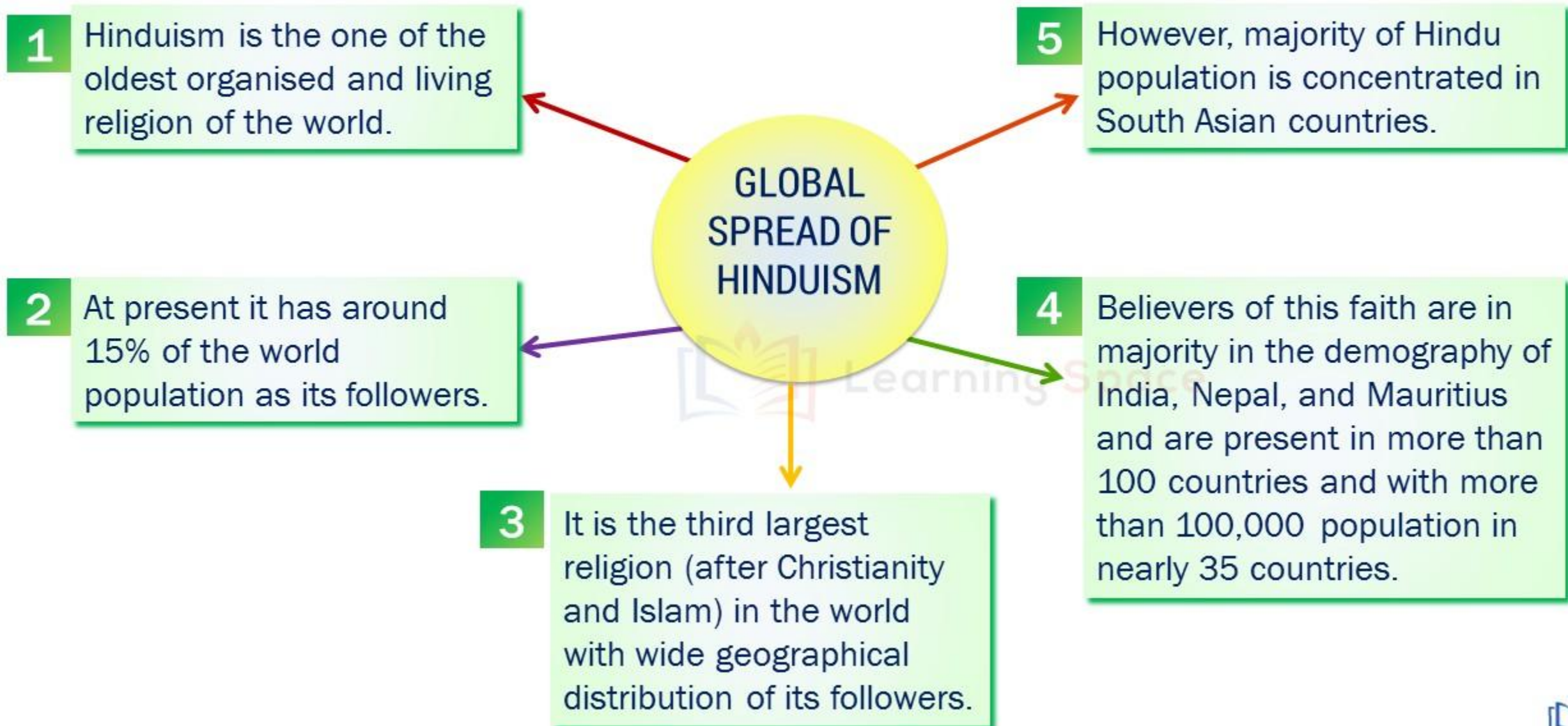
Thus,

- Philosophy provided a correct view of **reality**, while religion showed the correct **way of life**.
- Philosophy provided the **vision**, while religion brought about the **fulfilment**.
- Philosophy was the **theory** and religion was the **practice**.

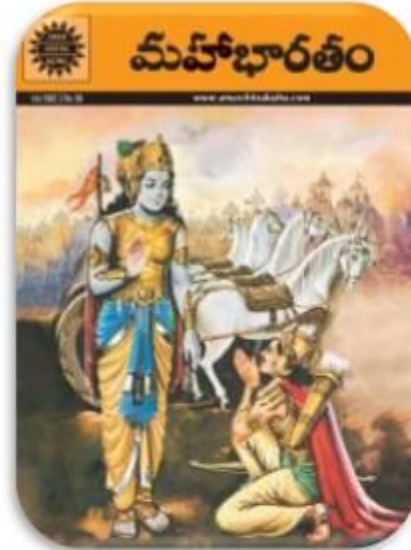
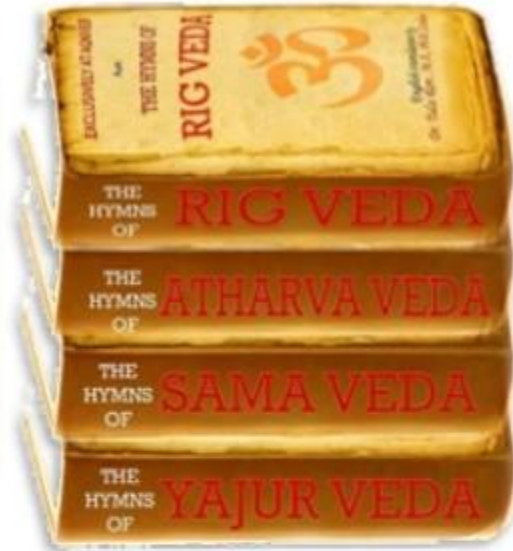
Thus in ancient India, philosophy and religion complemented each other.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

HINDUISM - AN INTRODUCTION



HINDUISM - AN INTRODUCTION



- 6 Hinduism as a religion does not have an origin at a **single point of time**, a **singular religious preacher** to whom it could own its genesis, a **singular scripture** to which its philosophy can be attributed, or even a **single faith** which can define it.
- 7 It is a conglomeration of beliefs, faiths, and philosophies.
- 8 It is a religion which has grown over nearly 4000 years.
- 9 Numerous scriptures (the Vedas, the Puranas, the Ramayana, the Mahabharata, the Gita, and others) contain its philosophy.

HINDUISM - AN INTRODUCTION



- 10** Numerous sages and reformers have contributed to its growth as it has evolved assimilating numerous beliefs and philosophies in it.

- 11** The very word 'Hinduism' is of later origin, referring to the people in the valley of river Sindhu (Indus) and beyond it.

- 12** In the early period of this growth, the faith has been referred to Sanatan Dharma the eternal or universal religion, or Varnashram Dharma, a faith based on fulfilment of duties based on Varna (class) and Ashram (stage of life), or a Vaidik Dharma, a faith based on principle of the Vedas.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

HINDUISM – A BRIEF HISTORY

The Vedic religion and texts are said to be nearly 3500 years old. The growth of the Vedic faith has been divided into several periods of development.

1. Early Vedic Phase
2. Later Vedic Phase
3. The Golden Period of Hinduism
4. Age of Adi Shankara and Advaita Vedanta
5. Bhakti Movement
6. The Modern Era and Phase of Reforms

THE VEDIC PHASE

- 1 The period from 1500 BCE to 500 BCE is usually referred as the Vedic period.
- 2 The four Vedas, the Rigveda, the Samveda, the Atharvaveda, and the Yajurveda are said to have been composed in this period, the Rigveda being of the earliest origin amongst the four.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

HINDUISM – A BRIEF HISTORY

EARLY VEDIC PHASE AND LATER VEDIC PHASE

RIGVEDA
SAMVEDA
YAJURVEDA
ATHARVAVEDA

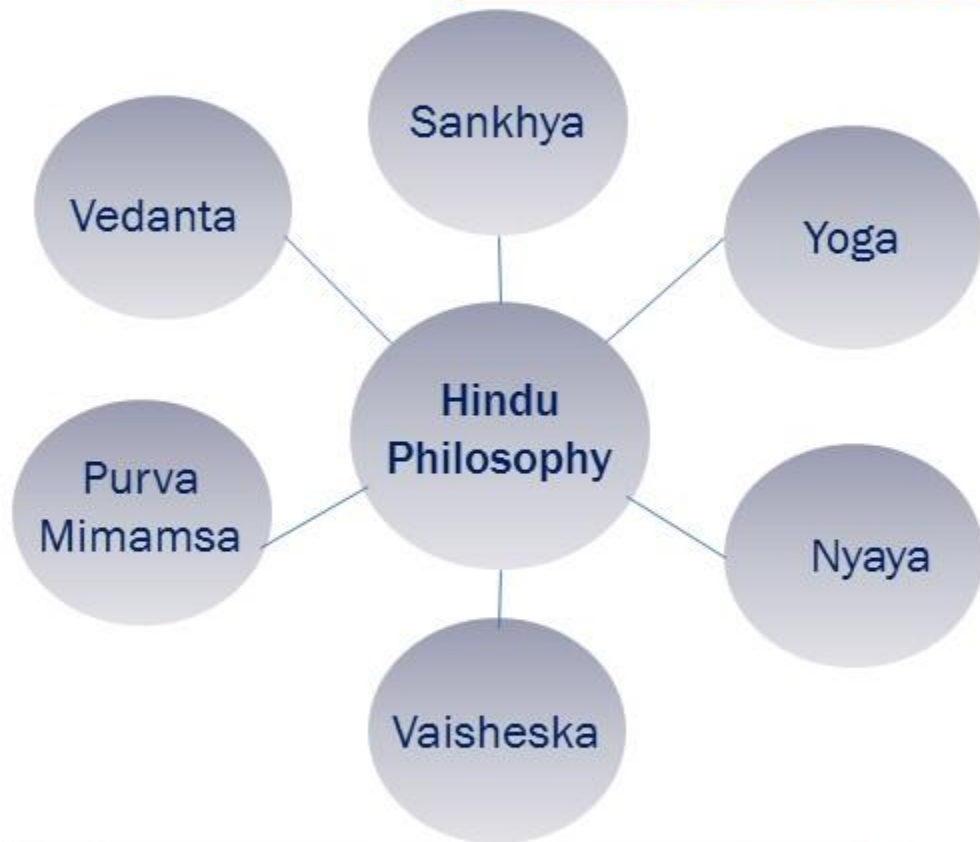


- 1 The Vedic phase is further divided into the **early Vedic phase** (1500-1000 BCE) and **later Vedic phase** (1000-500 BC).
- 2 The **advent of Buddhism and Jainism** marked the next phase in the growth of the Vedic religion (500 BCE to 200 BCE).
- 3 This was a period of upheaval as there was opposition to the **Brahmanical superiority**, **animal scarifies** and **challenge to the authority of the ritualistic/tradition** of the Vedas by the two upcoming faiths.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

HINDUISM – A BRIEF HISTORY

THE GOLDEN PERIOD OF HINDUISM



1 The next 700 to 800 years can be described as a golden period for growth of Hinduism.

2 This phase also coincides in history with the **Gupta period**.

3 The six branches of Hindu philosophy came into vogue in this period (Shad-Darshanas) –

- Nyaya,
- Vaisheshika,
- Samkhya,
- Yoga,
- Purva Mimamsa, and
- Vedanta

4 The growth of the Puranas or the advent of the Puranic Hindu culture succeeds this period.

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HINDUISM – A BRIEF HISTORY

THE AGE OF ADI SHANKARA AND ADVAITA VEDANTA



- 1 Towards the end of this phase came the **doctrine of Advaita Vedanta** propounded and consolidated by Sri **Adi Shankaracharya** (8th century CE).
- 2 He unified the various sects and streams of Hinduism in vogue then and founded the **four Mathas (monasteries)** which gave a formal structure to Hinduism and helped in its revival.
- 3 This was followed by the emergence of **Vishista Advaita** (propounded by Ramanuja in 12th century CE) and **Dvaita** (propounded by Madhavacharya in the 13th century).

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HINDUISM – A BRIEF HISTORY

THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT



- 1 The Bhakti movement in medieval period (reached its zenith in 15th-17th century) was **another important epoch** in the growth of Hinduism.

- 2 It **began in the southern part** of the country and spread to the northern and eastern parts.
- 3 Ramananda, Vallabhacharya, Tukaram, Namdev, Mirabai, Nanak, Kabirdas, Soordas, Chaitanya, Tulsidas, etc. are associated with it.
- 4 The movement influenced reform within Hinduism more than giving it a new philosophy.
- 5 It **emphasised on devotion as a path for salvation** regardless of caste, gender, or other differences.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

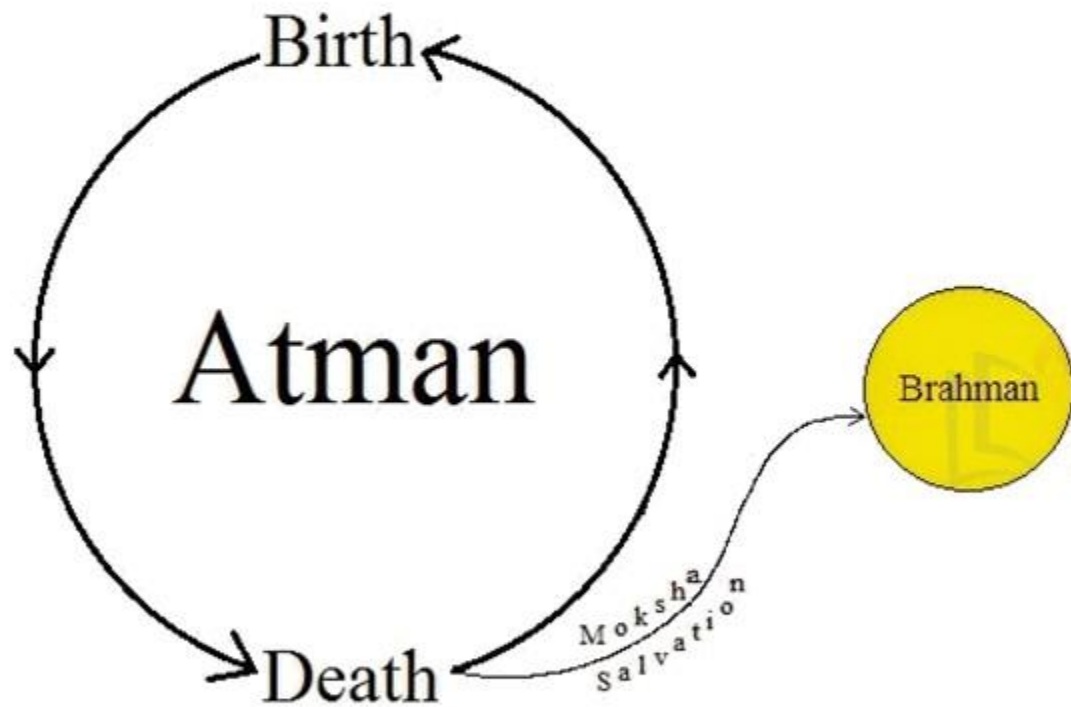
HINDUISM – A BRIEF HISTORY

THE MODERN ERA AND PHASE OF REFORMS



1 The 18th and 19th centuries saw another phase of reforms and revival in Hinduism - Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, Prathana Samaj, Ramakrishna Mission, etc.

2 Reformists like Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Dayananda Saraswati, Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar, Vivekananda, and others, endeavoured to purge it of many social events like sati, child marriages, untouchability, and caste systems and base it on various schools of philosophical thought.



1 Religion of the Rig Vedic people was very simple in the sense that it consisted mainly of worship of numerous deities representing the various phenomena of nature through prayers.

2 It was during the later Vedic period that **definite ideas and philosophies** about the true nature of soul or **Atman** and the cosmic principle or **Brahman** who represented the ultimate reality were developed.

QUICK FACT!

- **ORTHODOX SCHOOLS:** This school believed that Vedas were the supreme revealed scriptures that hold the secrets to salvation. They did not question the authenticity of the Vedas.
- **HETERODOX SCHOOLS:** They do not believe in the originality of the Vedas and questioned the existence of God.

3 These Vedic philosophical concepts later on gave rise to **six different schools of philosophies** called Shad Darshana.

4 They fall in the **category of the orthodox system as the final authority of the Vedas** is recognised by all of them.

5 Let us now find out more about these six schools of Indian philosophy.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

1

SAMKHYA SYSTEM

FOUNDER – MAHARISHI
KAPILA MUNI



1

The word “Samkhya” literally means “to count” or enumeration.

2

The Samkhya philosophy holds that reality is constituted of two principles one female and the other male i.e. **Prakriti**, **Purusha** respectively.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

1 SAMKHYA SYSTEM

3 Prakriti and Purusha are completely independent and absolute.

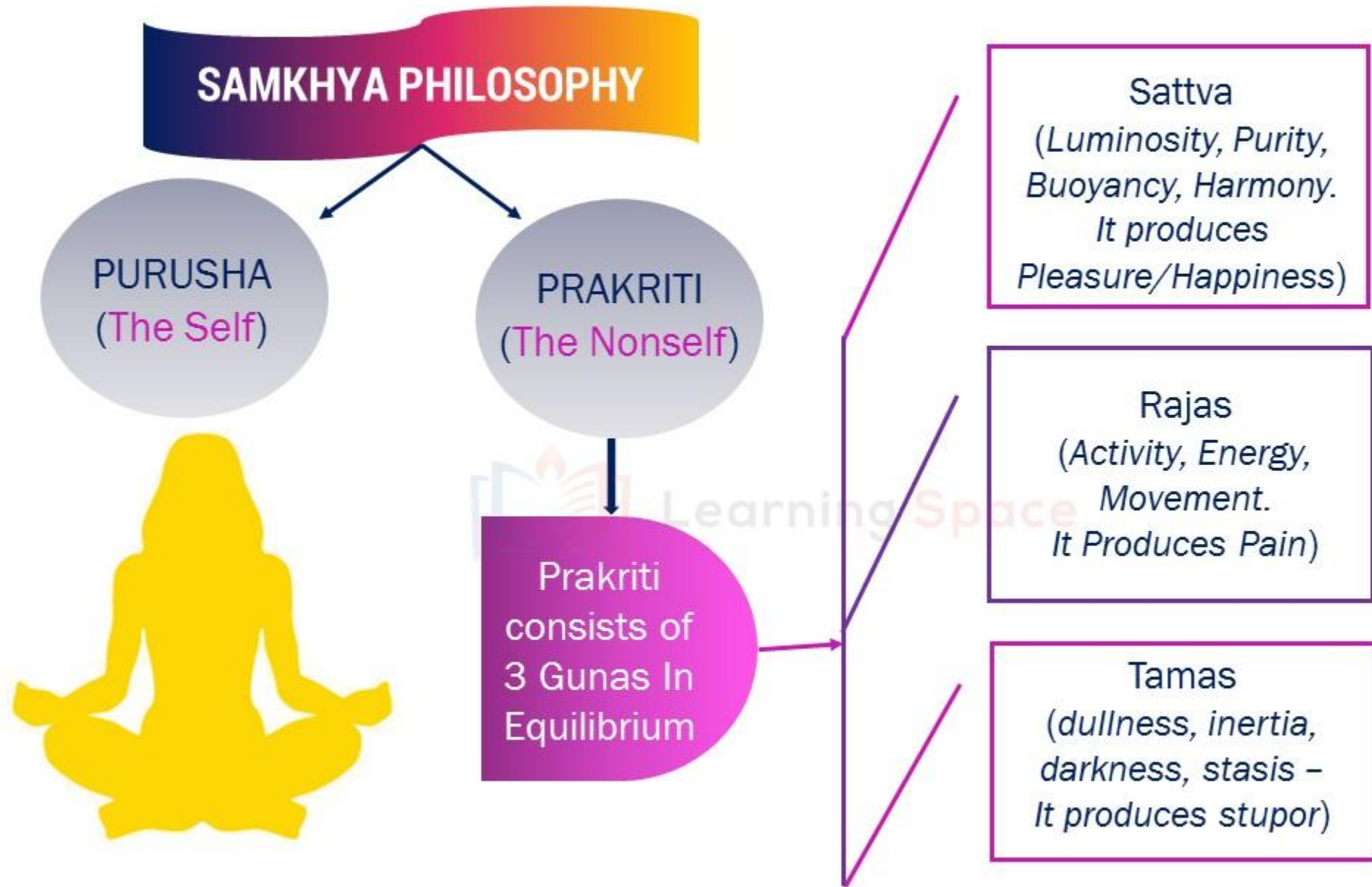
PURUSHA

According to this system, Purusha is mere consciousness or the self.

PRAKRITI

Prakriti on the other hand is composed of all the “matter” that is around the purusha ie everything else except Purusha.

The living being or Jiva exists as a result of the bond between the Purusha and Prakriti.



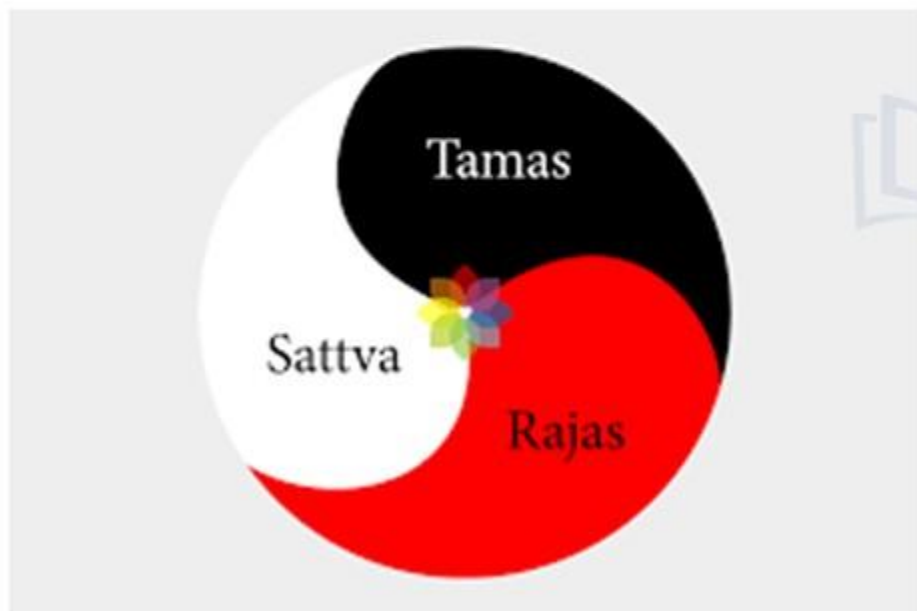
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VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

1

SAMKHYA SYSTEM

- 4 The Samkhya philosophy tries to establish some relationship between Purusha and Prakriti for explaining the creation of the universe.



- 5 Prakriti or nature comprises the three Gunas:
- **Sattva** (based on knowledge, illuminance, goodness, compassion, positivity, etc.)
 - **Rajas** (based on activity, passion, impulsiveness, and even chaos)
 - **Tamas** (based on ignorance, inaction, negativity, lethargy, destruction etc.)
- 6 All the three Gunas are present in different proportions in different life forms which will eventually lead to pleasure or pain.

RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

1 SAMKHYA SYSTEM

- 7 As per this school, life or jiva is a state in which purusha is bonded to prakriti through the glue of desire and the end of this bondage is moksha.



- 8 Due to the bondage of purusha with prakriti there is endless transmigration and suffering.
- 9 Thus, the Samkhya school believes in the existence of many living souls (Jivatmas).
- 10 It also believed in the cycles of transmigration of souls.
- 11 However, it does not describe what happens after moksha and does not mention anything about god.

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